

DRYWALL PRO

Drywall Tools & Materials Checklist

Your complete guide to getting equipped right



Print this checklist and take it to the store

01 Essential Tools

Check off each tool as you acquire it. Recommended brands and price ranges included.

MEASURING & LAYOUT

☐ Tape Measure (25 ft) Stanley FatMax	\$15 - \$25
☐ Drywall T-Square (48") Johnson Level	\$20 - \$35
☐ Chalk Line & Chalk For marking stud lines	\$8 - \$15
☐ Carpenter's Pencil Flat profile, won't roll	\$2 - \$5
☐ Level (4 ft) Stabila or equivalent	\$30 - \$50

CUTTING

☐ Utility Knife Stanley, retractable with extra blades	\$10 - \$15
☐ Drywall Saw (Jab Saw) For outlet and switch cutouts	\$12 - \$20
☐ Spiral Saw / Rotary Tool Rotozip or RotoSaw	\$50 - \$80

HANGING

☐ Drill / Screw Gun DeWalt cordless, adjustable clutch	\$80 - \$150
☐ Dimple Bit (#2 Phillips) Sets screws just below surface	\$8 - \$12
☐ Drywall Lift / Panel Hoist Rental recommended for ceilings	\$30 - \$50 rental
☐ Panel Carrier Grip handle for moving sheets	\$15 - \$25

TAPING & FINISHING

☐ Taping Knives (6", 8", 12") Marshalltown blue steel set	\$30 - \$60
☐ Mud Pan (12") Stainless steel, comfort grip	\$10 - \$15
☐ Inside Corner Tool For clean 90-degree corners	\$15 - \$25
☐ Banjo Taper Applies tape and mud simultaneously	\$30 - \$60

SANDING

☐ Sanding Pole (adjustable) With 150/220 grit screens	\$20 - \$35
☐ Sanding Sponge (fine) For detail work and edges	\$5 - \$10
☐ Vacuum Sander Dustless sanding, optional upgrade	\$200 - \$400

SAFETY GEAR

☐ N95 Respirator Essential for sanding dust	\$15 - \$25
☐ Safety Glasses Anti-fog, wraparound	\$10 - \$15
☐ Work Gloves Cut-resistant, flexible	\$8 - \$15
☐ Knee Pads Gel cushion, adjustable straps	\$20 - \$40

Pro Tip: Start with the Starter Kit below. Add specialty tools (vacuum sander, banjo taper) as your projects grow. Rent expensive tools like the drywall lift for one-time jobs.

02 Starter Kit Budget

Everything you need for your first project, prioritized by importance.

CATEGORY	EST. COST
Measuring & Layout (tape, T-square, chalk, pencil, level)	\$75 - \$130
Cutting (utility knife, jab saw)	\$22 - \$35
Hanging (drill/screw gun, dimple bit, panel carrier)	\$103 - \$187
Taping & Finishing (knife set, mud pan, corner tool)	\$55 - \$100
Sanding (pole, sponge)	\$25 - \$45
Safety (respirator, glasses, gloves, knee pads)	\$53 - \$95

CATEGORY	EST. COST
Total Starter Kit	\$333 - \$592

Budget Tip: Focus on quality for your drill and tapping knives first -- they make the biggest difference. A mid-range DeWalt drill and Marshalltown knife set will last for years of projects.

03 Materials Reference

Know what to buy for each situation. Check off what your project needs.

Drywall Panels

- **1/2" Standard** -- most common for walls
- **5/8" Standard** -- ceilings, reduces sag
- **5/8" Type X** -- fire-rated, garages & code
- **Moisture Resistant** -- green board, kitchens
- **Cement Board** -- tile backer, wet areas

Joint Compound

- **All-Purpose** -- bedding, filling, finishing
- **Lightweight** -- easier sanding, top coats
- **Setting-Type (Hot Mud)** -- fast set, high strength, 20/45/90 min options

Setting-type for first coat, lightweight for finish coats = best results.

Tape

- **Paper Tape** -- strongest, best for corners, requires pre-mudding
- **Mesh Tape (self-adhesive)** -- fast flat seams, use with setting compound only

Paper tape is the pro standard. Mesh is faster but weaker on inside corners.

Screws

- **Coarse Thread** -- wood studs, most common
- **Fine Thread** -- metal studs only

Length: 1-1/4" for 1/2" drywall, 1-5/8" for 5/8" drywall.

Corner Bead

- **Metal Corner Bead** -- durable, nail or crimp on, standard outside corners
- **Vinyl Corner Bead** -- won't rust or dent, spray adhesive or staple
- **Paper-Faced Corner Bead** -- mudded on, smooth finish, less cracking, pro favorite

Paper-faced is becoming the industry standard for its superior finish and crack resistance.

Shopping List Formula: Measure your square footage, divide by 32 (area of a 4x8 sheet) and add 10% for waste. For compound, plan about 1 gallon of ready-mix per 100 sq ft of drywall, plus extra for repairs.

QUICK MATERIALS CHECKLIST

☐ **Drywall panels** Type: _____ Qty: _____

☐ **Joint compound** Type: _____ Qty: _____

☐ **Tape** Paper / Mesh Qty: _____

☐ **Screws** Coarse / Fine Size: _____ Qty: _____

☐ **Corner bead** Metal / Vinyl / Paper-faced Qty: _____

NEXT STEP

You've Got the Right Tools. Now Master the Technique.

This checklist gives you everything you need to get equipped. Now head back to the main guide and follow the step-by-step process for professional-quality drywall installation.

With the right tools and the right technique, your results will look like a seasoned pro did the work.



Open the main Drywall Pro guide and start with Chapter 1.

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